Vosotros: mandatos en -d

Telling a group what to do: commands ending in -d

The short answer: These are the positive vosotros commands: how you tell a group of friends to do something, used only in Spain. You need them every time you address two or more people you would call tú: your mates at five-a-side, flatmates, a group at the bar. The rule never breaks: take the infinitive, drop the final -r and add -d (hablar → hablad, venir → venid). Two traps only: a negative switches to the subjunctive (no habléis), and a reflexive drops the -d before -os (sentaos, callaos).

01 How to form it: drop -r, add -d

Start from the infinitive, not from a conjugated form. Remove the -r, put -d in its place. This works for -ar, -er and -ir verbs, and even for ir and ser.

Infinitive	Vosotros command	English
hablar	hablad	Talk! (to a group)
comer	comed	Eat!
vivir	vivid	Live!
tener	tened	Here, take this! / Have!
venir	venid	Come!
ir	id	Go! (yes, just "id")
ser	sed	Be! (sed buenos = be good)

Ejemplo	English
Niños, comed un poco más antes de salir.	Kids, eat a bit more before you go out.
¡Venid, que va a empezar la peli!	Come on, the film's about to start!

02 No irregulars (unlike tú)

The tú command has eight short irregulars (di, haz, pon...). Vosotros has none: the same -d rule covers all of them. If you know the infinitive, you know the command.

Verb	tú (irregular)	vosotros (regular)
decir	di	decid
hacer	haz	haced
poner	pon	poned
salir	sal	salid
tener	ten	tened
venir	ven	venid

Verb	tú (irregular)	vosotros (regular)
ir	ve	id

Ejemplo	English
Tú: ¡Ven aquí! · Vosotros: ¡Venid aquí!	Come here! (to one person) · Come here! (to a group)
Haced lo que queráis, a mí me da igual.	Do whatever you want, I don't mind.

03 Negatives lose the -d

The -d form is only ever positive. To say "don't" to a group, use no + the vosotros present subjunctive: -ar verbs end in -éis, -er and -ir verbs end in -áis. Irregular verbs keep their subjunctive stem.

Positive	Negative (subjunctive)	Pattern
hablad	no habléis	-ar → -éis
comed	no comáis	-er → -áis
vivid	no viváis	-ir → -áis
tened	no tengáis	irregular stem
venid	no vengáis	irregular stem
haced	no hagáis	irregular stem

Ojo: "No hablad" is never correct. Once you add no, the -d disappears.

Ejemplo	English
¡Hablad más alto! Pero no habléis todos a la vez.	Speak up! But don't all talk at once.
No vengáis antes de las nueve, que no estoy en casa.	Don't come before nine, I won't be home.

04 Reflexives: the -d drops before -os

With reflexive verbs you add -os, and the -d falls away: sentad + os = sentaos. With -ir verbs an accent appears on the i to keep it a separate syllable (vestíos). Irse is the one exception, with two accepted forms.

Infinitive	Vosotros command	English
sentarse	sentaos	Sit down! (not "sentados")
levantarse	levantaos	Get up!
callarse	callaos	Be quiet!
darse prisa	daos prisa	Hurry up!
ponerse	poneos	Put on! / Stand (there)!
vestirse	vestíos	Get dressed! (-ir: accent on í)
irse	idos / iros	Off you go! (the one exception)

Ejemplo	English
Chicos, sentaos y callaos un momento.	Guys, sit down and be quiet for a moment.
¡Daos prisa, que llegamos tarde!	Hurry up, we're going to be late!
Poneos cómodos, estáis en vuestra casa.	Make yourselves comfortable, make yourselves at home.

05 Adding other pronouns (and the accent)

Other pronouns (me, nos, lo, la, le) simply stick onto the -d form, which stays. With one pronoun no accent is needed. With two pronouns the stress falls three syllables from the end, so it needs a written accent.

Parts	Result	English
tened + lo	tenedlo	Hold it!
decid + me	decidme	Tell me!
dad + me + lo	dádmelo	Give it to me!
pasad + me + lo	pasádmelo	Pass it to me!
decid + nos + lo	decídnoslo	Tell us!

Ejemplo	English
- ¿Os cuento el secreto? - ¡Sí, decídnoslo ya!	- Shall I tell you the secret? - Yes, tell us now!
Tenéis el balón, pasádmelo.	You've got the ball, pass it to me.

06 The ones you'll actually hear in Spain

A handful of these come up constantly: at the door, in the street, at football. Learn them as fixed phrases.

Spanish	English	When
¡Venid!	Come (here)!	calling a group over
¡Mirad!	Look!	pointing something out
¡Esperad!	Wait!	hang on a second
¡Pasad!	Come in!	welcoming people in
¡Tened!	Here, take this!	handing things over
¡Tened cuidado!	Be careful!	warning a group
¡Corred!	Run!	the bus is leaving

Ejemplo	English
¡Venga, corred, que se va el autobús!	Come on, run, the bus is leaving!
Pasad, pasad, dejad los abrigos en la cama.	Come in, come in, leave your coats on the bed.

07 Pronunciation and street reality

In real speech the final -d is so soft it almost disappears: ¡Mirad! sounds like "¡Mira(d)!". Many native speakers also use the infinitive instead (¡Venir!, ¡Callaros!). It is very common, but it is considered incorrect, so do not copy it in writing.

Standard	What you'll hear	Status
¡Venid!	¡Venir!	common, incorrect
¡Sentaos!	¡Sentaros!	common, incorrect
¡Callaos!	¡Callaros!	common, incorrect
¡Idos!	¡Iros!	now accepted by the RAE

Clave: If you hear "¡Sentaros!" from a Spaniard, understand it, but say "¡Sentaos!" yourself. Nobody will ever correct you for being right.

Ejemplo	English
Correcto: ¡Sentaos! · En la calle: ¡Sentaros!	Correct: Sit down! · What you'll hear in the street (wrong but common).
Bueno, iros ya, que es tardísimo.	Right, off you go, it's really late.

08 Chuleta rápida: talking to a group

Situation	Say	Why
Tell them to do it	Venid. / Haced.	infinitive -r → -d, no irregulars
Tell them not to	No vengáis. / No hagáis.	no + subjunctive, no -d
Reflexive	Sentaos. / Daos prisa.	drop -d, add -os
-ir reflexive	Vestíos.	accent on the í
Go away	Idos. / Iros.	the one exception
With two pronouns	Dádmelo.	-d stays, written accent